

Apple releases open source language 'Pkl' for configuration management



Apple has unleashed Pkl (pronounced as 'pickle'), a game-changing open source language designed for configuration management. Departing from the norm, Pkl simplifies the intricate task of handling settings through a user-friendly key-value format, unlike traditional imperative languages.

Simply put, instead of navigating complex scripts, users tell Pkl their desired outcomes, and the language handles the rest. "Imagine you have many settings for different things, like your phone brightness or Wi-Fi password. Instead of writing complicated instructions, you just tell Pkl what you want the outcome to be, and it takes care of the rest," explained a spokesperson from Apple.

Beyond user-friendliness, Pkl prioritises data integrity and security through measures such as type checking, sandboxing, and the principle of least privilege. Versatile in configuring various systems and applications, Pkl has been an internal asset at Apple for years. Now, as an open source project, it invites community contributions and broader adoption.

Basic editor plugins for VS Code and Neovim further enhance the user experience, providing syntax highlighting and code folding. Apple's move to release Pkl aligns with its commitment to open source software, seen in past contributions like the Swift programming language and Foundation libraries.

Pkl stands out as a promising tool, bridging the gap for efficient configuration management while embracing collaboration within the programming community.

NCS reports the progress made in securing open source software

The Office of the National Cyber Director (NCS) in the US government has released the End of Year Report on the Open Source Software Security Initiative (OS3I). The report outlines advancements in securing open source software, acknowledging the

WearPico, the Raspberry Pi-powered smartwatch

A new player has emerged in the dynamic world of wearables – WearPico. Developed by Umut Sevdi, an innovative maker, this open source smartwatch is breaking the mould, utilising Raspberry Pi Pico W to create a unique, customisable wrist companion. Sevdi emphasised the project's accessibility, stating, "It is relatively easy to build."

Built on the compact Raspberry Pi Pico W, WearPico transforms a developer board into a versatile smartwatch. The open source ethos allows users to assemble their own device, making it a distinctive addition to the wearable tech landscape.

WearPico isn't just about aesthetics; it's a feature-rich experience detailed by Sevdi on GitHub, encouraging users to explore modifications and collaborate on the project. "It is also possible to modify the project as well as to collaborate on it," said Sevdi.

With a user-friendly interface mirroring mainstream smartwatches,



WearPico supports touch gestures alongside basic touch inputs. Beyond timekeeping, it displays notifications, controls media,

sets timers, and records health data. The incorporation of an acceleration sensor and vibration motor enhances functionality, allowing step tracking and haptic notifications.

Umut Sevdi's commitment extends beyond hardware, documenting the entire project on GitHub and providing the necessary software, emphasising community engagement.